

Dear Admissions Committee,

**RE: RECOMMENDATION LETTER FOR OTIENO ROBERT COMMONAPP ID 28541595**

It is with great pleasure that I recommend Otieno Robert for admission to your institution. I worked with Robert over the summer of 2022 and I have never seen an intern quite like him. He was an industrious, innovative, lively and reliable colleague throughout his internship.

It is absolutely rare to find an intern as lively, optimistic and verdant as Robert. The first thing I noticed about Robert was that he would greet everyone respectfully with a vibrant smile. There was always an air of positivity around him. Before we began our work during morning tea, he would engage my colleagues with banter. He liked to indulge us in answering the question whether robots would replace humans entirely. He had this specific habit of damping depression in our brains through elaborations like self-driving cars currently on test at Tesla and use of drones in disaster-stricken areas, re-affirming that soon we would be replaced with robots in our workforce. He would then switch, giving us hope that there are technicalities in the workforce that robots wouldn't be able to handle finishing off with Rudyard Kipling's line that machines will never be anything but children of the human brain. In the midst of duties as our team was exhausted and there was still work to be done, Robert inspired us to press on until the day's tasks were completed through his music. He would lead on in a local Swahili tune. One voice joined, then another and another until the whole team was singing, making us forget the exhaustion we felt before, only focusing on singing and working. His presence became fundamental in our efficiency as a team. I will miss his presence in our team, and moreso, his banter.

Robert had an inspiring adventurous spirit, pushing himself to explore and learn as much as possible. When he joined the maintenance department, Robert hardly knew the technicals concerned with our department despite being affluent with basic engineering concepts. He had vague knowledge about reprogramming lifts, setting and crimping data cables and fixing electric generators. However, he was always curious. On one occasion when he accompanied me to reprogram the elevators, he was asking questions on what the language used was to program the elevators and how resetting is done. He took a few pictures of the command prompt, saying he would learn all about it in the evening after work. The next time one of the lifts was to be reset, Robert volunteered to do it to test the knowledge and practical skills he acquired. To our surprise, he managed to reset the lift correctly and when asked where he learnt to reset, he would reply back with a smile that he read it overnight. I was shocked at how he had mastered the base programs of C++ in programming lifts.

Robert possessed an utmost sense of initiative. When he arrived at work early before everyone else, he would go over sections of the hotel and machines our team had worked on the day before and finalize them. In the afternoon when we grew weary and fellow interns were looking at each other to see who would fix the remaining generators, Robert stood up and worked on them. I remember he would say work does not happen when people look at each other to see who would work. When I was not around to make significant decisions on how duties or processes were to be handled, Robert took charge and led his fellow interns in areas and machines he thought needed scrutiny. When we were setting data cables for the hotel rooms, I was not around. The team and Robert were caught in a dilemma of deciding whether the television data cable will have a socket of its own different from the internet cable. Robert decided instead

of leaning on one socket they accommodate the possibility of different sockets. So, he led the team in placing the cables through conduits, leaving one cable at the center for the television and directing another to the ground close to the internet socket. On coming back, he would walk me over what they had done, consulting whether they did it right or not. Once he mixed data cables with electric cables and I advised him to keep them separate. The next day before we began duties, he was in the ceilings of hotel rooms placing them on different cable trays. He constantly depicted initiative in action and in owning up his mistakes. I was happy at his willingness to own up, correct the mistake and learn how to solve it.

Robert is a calm and methodical engineering prospect. In areas where his fellow interns were scared or intimidated by the weight of the duties, Robert was always calm, following instructions to a tee. Once when handling 250V cable from a transformer, other interns shied away. Robert, however, wore his safety boots, gloves and spectacles and proved to be up to the task. He switched off the Mains supply. Using a tester to check for charge, he found the circuit had been broken then climbed a ladder to insulate the 250V. He would confirm his approach in a step by step process, seeking clarifications from us below. It was like watching a chemist in a laboratory performing titration, checking for volumes and confirming ions in a chemical.

Robert through his calm and methodical approach to problem solving, adventurous spirit will benefit from your institution. Through his verdant nature and sense of initiative, I am certain he will bring value to your community.

Yours sincerely,

Fredrick  
Chief Engineer-